

JURASSIC ENGLISH™

JE Level 4 Mastery Teacher Pack

Forty ready lesson plans for teaching Level 4 Mastery (ages 12–14): full novels, counterargument and rebuttal, formal debate.

Level 4 Mastery | **Ages 12–14** | **CEFR B1 → B2** | **40 lesson plans**

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What you get in this pack

Everything you need to plan and teach the course: the syllabus, the method, and forty lesson plans built on the Jurassic Thinking Cycle (Excavation, Strata, Justification, Impact).

159	**printable A4 pages** This licensed PDF: syllabus, manual and all forty lesson plans, with a contents page.
40	**lesson plans** Each with aims, materials, a timed four-phase procedure, differentiation, an assessment rubric, closure and homework.
1	**Teacher Implementation Manual** The method, the four stages of the Thinking Cycle, classroom routines, assessment and troubleshooting.
1	**Student & Family Syllabus** Course aims, core texts, term-by-term plan and the four-level reasoning rubric.
17	**editable Google Docs** The same material as Google Docs in the buyer's Drive folder, so you can adapt wording for your classes.

The set books are not included and none is quoted. Use copies your school or library owns.

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1. Introduction to Jurassic English™ Level 4

1.1 Mission Statement: Interpretive Agency and Systemic Critique

At Level 4: Mastery, the Jurassic English™ curriculum enters the realm of critical discourse analysis. Designed for learners aged 12–14, Level 4 is engineered to cultivate **Interpretive Agency**. At this stage, students no longer assume the text is a neutral window into a story. Instead, they learn to read the *narrator*, interrogate the *structure*, and deconstruct the *language of manipulation*. The mission is to transition students from consuming literature to diagnosing it, treating English as a high-precision instrument for political, moral, and systemic evaluation.

1.2 Pedagogical Positioning: Conquering the B2 Plateau

Level 4 attacks the notorious "B2 Plateau"—the most cognitively demanding stage in language development, where progress often stalls. To move from B1 to B2, learners must master abstract concepts, subtext, irony, and multi-perspectival analysis. We conquer this plateau not by drilling complex grammar, but by demanding complex thought. By grappling with full novels, contested interpretations, and real-world stakes, the linguistic sophistication (advanced conditionals, passive voice in academic writing, nuanced modals) emerges as a necessary byproduct of the intellectual demand.

1.3 Standards Alignment: CEFR B1 → B2 & CCSS Anchors

The Mastery level maps directly to upper-secondary global benchmarks, preparing students for the rigorous demands of pre-university curricula (IGCSE, MYP, Pre-AP).

Standard	Level 4 Descriptor	JE Instructional Evidence
CEFR B1	Can understand the main points of clear standard input and produce simple connected text.	Baseline entry requirement; fluent execution of independent CEIW paragraphs.
CEFR B2	Can understand the main ideas of complex text on both concrete and abstract topics; can produce clear, detailed text and explain a viewpoint giving advantages and disadvantages.	Weighing competing readings of a text without teacher scaffolding; executing rhetorical analysis of propaganda.
CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.R.CCR.8	Delineate and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, assessing whether the reasoning is valid.	Stage 1 & 2: Delineating circular logic, redefinition, and appeals to fear in character dialogue.
CCSS.ELA-LITERACY.W.CCR.9	Draw evidence from literary or informational texts to support analysis, reflection, and research.	Stage 3: The CEIW+Impact formal analytical essay structure.

1.4 Core Cognitive Progression: The Stratigraphy of Power

Level 4 advances the cognitive architecture through a four-step framework focused on power and systems:

1. **Linguistic Deconstruction:** Analyzing *how* language manipulates reality (e.g., identifying circular logic or redefinition).

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2. **Structural Evaluation:** Moving beyond individual character choices to evaluate systemic inevitability (e.g., "Is totalitarianism determined by structure or character?").
3. **Advanced Synthesis (CEIW+Impact):** Fusing the textual argument (CEIW) and the real-world consequence (Impact) into a single, cohesive academic argument.
4. **Intertextual & Global Mapping:** Explicitly linking the allegory of the text to a named, specific real-world political or ecological context.

1.5 World Wise Learning — Publisher Statement

World Wise Learning (WWL) categorizes Level 4 as the crucial inflection point for media literacy and civic readiness. In a digital age saturated with misinformation, the ability to recognize how vocabulary is weaponized to short-circuit rational thought is a survival skill. This manual provides the blueprint for transforming the English classroom into a laboratory for truth.

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Lesson 13: Excavation — Visual Rhetoric and Linguistic Deconstruction in Persepolis

Target Grade Level / Subject / Duration

- **Grade Level:** Ages 12–14 years
- **CEFR Level:** B1 → B2 (Conquering the B2 Plateau)
- **Subject:** English Language Arts (Jurassic English™ Level 4: Mastery)
- **Duration:** 45 minutes

Overall Learning Goals

Students open the *Persepolis* dig site and expand the Excavation toolkit. Marjane Satrapi's graphic memoir delivers argument through TWO simultaneous channels — words AND images. Today: deconstruct how the panel composition, the high-contrast black-and-white inking, and the child-narrator's voice operate together as a rhetorical mechanism. The text demands the reader analyze what the picture says that the caption cannot.

> ***Teacher Pre-Note:*** *This is the first text in the JE library that uses visual rhetoric as a primary argumentation channel. Anchor the historical context BEFORE opening the panel: the Iranian Revolution of 1979, the Shah's fall, the establishment of the Islamic Republic, the mandatory veil, the Iran-Iraq War. The manual is explicit: "Do not teach the text without its historical/political anchor."*

Specific Learning Objectives

1. Students will independently regulate.
2. Students will deconstruct at least one panel using a Visual Rhetoric Decoder — analyzing composition, contrast, framing, and the gap between image and caption.
3. Students will identify the rhetorical mechanism (Redefinition, Appeal to Fear, or Circular Logic) operating in the regime's language as Satrapi's child-narrator reports it.
4. Students will use B2 mechanism verbs (*illustrates, exposes, dismantles, manufactures*) to articulate how the dual visual-verbal channel functions.

Materials Needed

- Core Text: *Persepolis* by Marjane Satrapi (physical copies for all students).
- One-page historical anchor handout: Iran 1979 — the Shah's fall, the Revolution, the Islamic Republic, the veil decree, the Iran-Iraq War (1980–88).
- **Visual Rhetoric Decoder** (4-column graphic organizer: Panel composition / Caption text / Gap between image and caption / Rhetorical function).
- **Mechanism Verbs Reference Card.**
- Highlighters.
- Cool Down Passes.

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- Accountable Talk Reference Cards.

Detailed Procedure / Step-by-Step Outline

Phase 1: Regulation & Historical Anchor (0–8 minutes)

- **Teacher Scripting Prompt:** "*New text. New rhetorical channel. Before we open the book, the historical anchor is non-negotiable. Iran. 1979. The Shah falls. The Islamic Republic establishes the mandatory veil for all women regardless of religion. Eight years of war with Iraq begin in 1980. Marjane Satrapi was ten. She drew this memoir 20 years later, in black and white, in France. Read the anchor. We open the book in three minutes.*"
- **Student Task:** Read the anchor handout silently.

Phase 2: The Dig Site — Reading Panel as Rhetoric (8–22 minutes)

- **Activity:** Reading the opening panels with attention to the dual channel.
- **Teacher Scripting Prompt:** "*Open to 'The Veil' — the opening chapter. Read it twice. First read: follow the words. Second read: ignore the words. Look at JUST the panels. What does the composition tell you? Where does Satrapi place herself in the panels — center, edge, behind a line? What does the high-contrast black-and-white DO to the emotional register?*"
- **Student Task:** Two reads of the opening chapter.
- **Teacher Move:** "*In the first panel of 'The Veil,' Marjane is small in the corner of a row of identical figures. The composition does what Hutu Power radio did with words — it ERASES her individuality. The picture is the propaganda critique.*"

Phase 3: Excavation — The Visual Rhetoric Decoder (22–37 minutes)

- **Activity:** Filling in the Decoder for two panels.
- **Teacher Scripting Prompt:** "*Two panels. For each: Column A — describe the composition (who is centered, who is at the edge, what is in shadow). Column B — copy the caption or dialogue verbatim. Column C — what is the GAP between image and caption? Where do they contradict or amplify? Column D — name the rhetorical function: Redefinition, Appeal to Fear, or Circular Logic.*"
- **Student Task:** Decoder completion for two panels.
- **Teacher Move:** Demand precision. "*You wrote 'the panel is sad.' Reject. WHAT in the composition manufactures sadness? Is the figure off-center? Are the eyes drawn or absent? Specifics.*"

Phase 4: Mechanism Verb Practice (37–43 minutes)

- **Activity:** Verbal articulation using B2 mechanism verbs.
- **Teacher Scripting Prompt:** "Pair work. For each Decoder you completed: 'Satrapi's panel composition ILLUSTRATES the regime's Redefinition by ___.' Or: 'The gap between caption and image EXPOSES that ___ has been replaced with ___.' Use mechanism verbs only."

Differentiation / Accommodations

- **Support (B1):** Pre-completed Decoder for one panel (Columns A and B filled). Student completes Columns C and D. Pre-printed list of three rhetorical functions for the student to choose from.
- **Core (Target B2):** Independent Decoder for two panels.

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- **Extension (Authorial Mimicry):** Draw a third panel that could appear NEXT in Satrapi's narrative. Use the same compositional logic. Annotate the rhetorical move beneath it.
- **Neuroinclusive (ASD / Literal):** Subtext Decoder for the caption-vs.-image gap — Column A: literal caption. Column B: what the panel image actually shows. Column C: the visual evidence that proves Satrapi intended the contradiction.
- **Neuroinclusive (ADHD):** Movement break for Phase 3 — student physically posts annotated sticky notes on a projected panel on the wall.
- **Neuroinclusive (Dyslexia):** Podcast Editorial alternative — describe the panels aloud rather than annotate in writing.

Assessment & Rubric

Specific Learning Objective	4 — Mastery (B2+)	3 — Proficient (B2)	2 — Developing (B1+)	1 — Emerging (Pre-B1)
1. Regulation	Pre-empts; supports peer.	Independent.	Prompting required.	Refuses.
2. Visual Rhetoric Decoder	Both panels decoded; gap between image and caption analyzed precisely.	Both panels decoded; gap identified.	One panel decoded; gap noted but vague.	Treats panel as illustration, not argument.
3. Rhetorical Function ID	Names function + provides linguistic + visual evidence.	Names function with one form of evidence.	Names function vaguely.	No function identified.
4. Mechanism Verbs	Multiple verbs, differentiated.	Mechanism verbs used naturally.	One verb mechanically.	"The text says" only.

Closure / Reflection (43–45 minutes)

- **Teacher Scripting Prompt:** "*Tomorrow's question: when Marjane's family chooses to stay in Iran during the war, are they brave — or are they trapped? Two equally defensible readings. Bring your Decoders.*"

Homework / Extension Activities

- **Task:** Find ONE more panel in the next chapter where the image and the caption contradict each other. Mark the page. We open Lesson 14 with these.

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